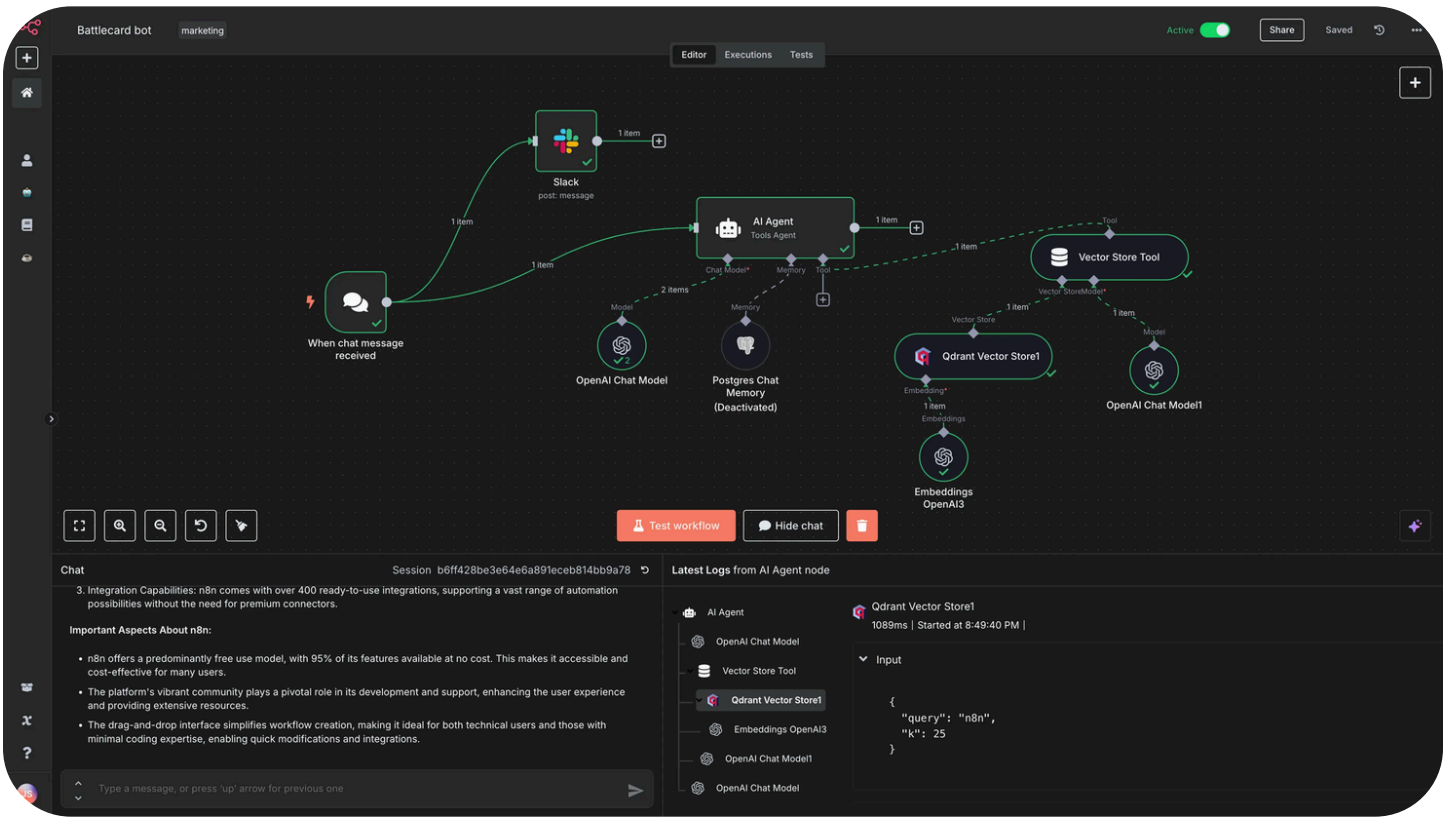
🧠 n8n JSON Validation Rules



1. UUID Generation

- NEVER use placeholder text like "GENERATED_UUID"

- ALWAYS generate realistic UUIDs like: "f47ac10b-58cc-4372-a567-0e02b2c3d479"

- Use actual UUID format: 8-4-4-4-12 hexadecimal characters

2. Node Type Verification

- ALWAYS use exact n8n node types from the reference examples

- Common corrections:

  * "sendEmail" → "emailSend"

  * "googleSheets" → "googleSheets" (but verify version)

  * "webhook" → "webhook" (correct)

- NEVER guess node type names

3. TypeVersion Accuracy

- Use exact typeVersion numbers from working examples:

  * emailSend: typeVersion 2

  * googleSheets: typeVersion 4

  * webhook: typeVersion 1

  * slack: typeVersion 1

- NEVER assume or increment versions

4. Parameter Structure Validation

- Google Sheets: Use "columns" object with "mappingMode": "defineBelow"

- Email nodes: Use simple "message" field, avoid complex HTML in JSON

- Webhook: Use "methods" array, not "method" string

- ALWAYS match parameter structure from reference examples exactly

5. JSON Syntax Enforcement

- NO trailing commas anywhere

- ALL strings properly quoted

- Expressions use proper n8n syntax: "={{ expression }}"

- NO unescaped quotes in message content

6. Pre-Import Testing Rule

MANDATORY: Before outputting any workflow JSON, perform this checklist:

✓ All UUIDs are valid format (not placeholders)

✓ All node types match reference examples exactly

✓ All typeVersions are from working examples

✓ All parameter structures follow reference patterns

✓ JSON syntax is valid (no trailing commas, proper quotes)

✓ Connection node names exist in nodes array

✓ No complex HTML/CSS in JSON string fields

7. Simplification Priority

- When in doubt, SIMPLIFY rather than add complexity

- Use plain text emails instead of HTML in JSON

- Use basic parameter structures over advanced ones

- Prefer working simple nodes over complex failing ones

8. Reference Validation

- ALWAYS cross-reference against the provided example workflows

- If no example exists for a node type, use minimal configuration

- NEVER add node types not seen in examples without explicit user request